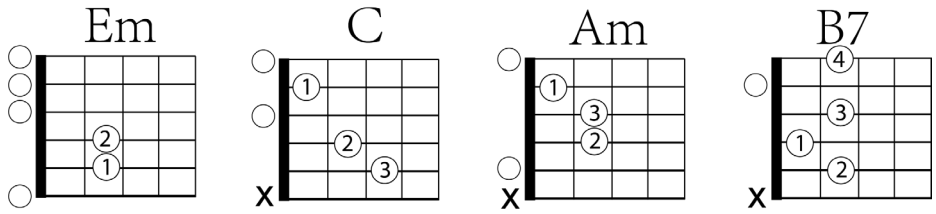
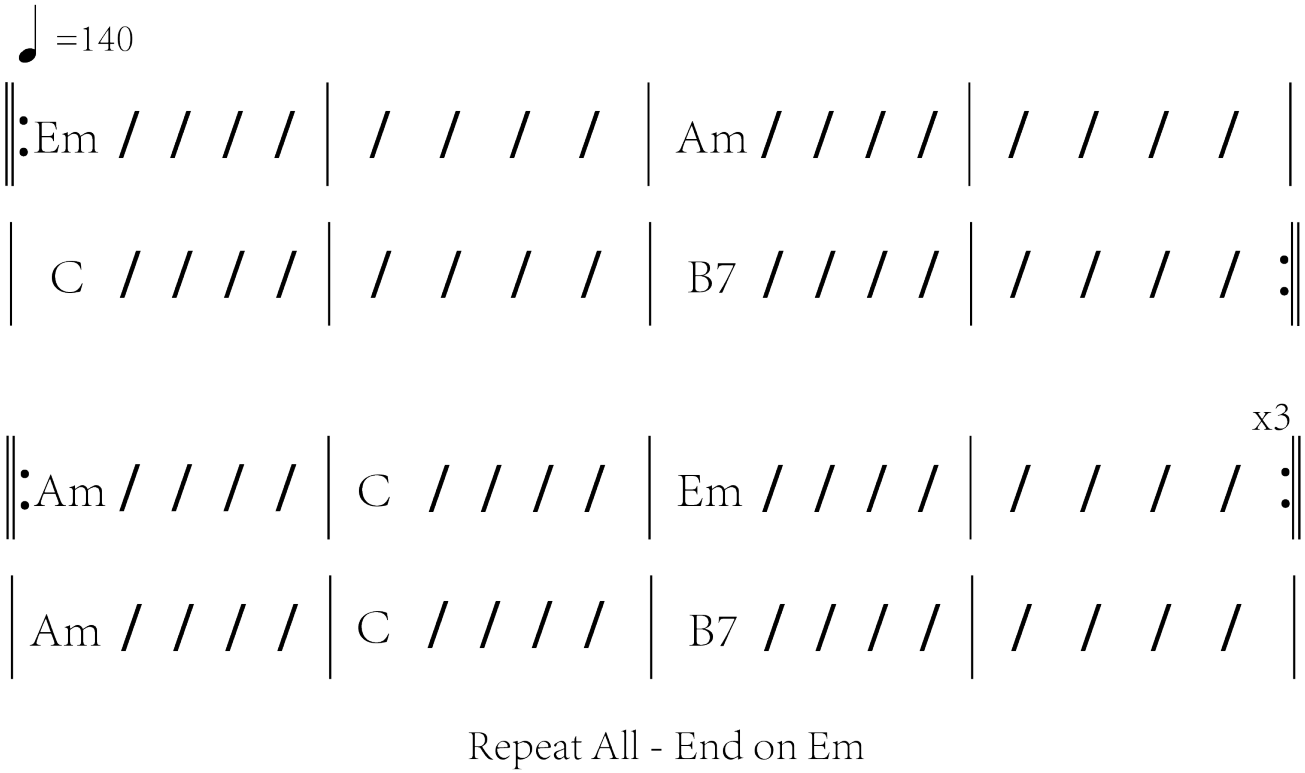
LESSON 17: READING AND PERFORMING CHORD SHEETS

Chord sheets, or chord charts, often just convey what chord to play and how many beats it sustains. You can't always expect them to tell you what rhythm to play. Fortunately, a learned musician like yourself has many rhythms, techniques, and patterns that they can use to fill in a measure.

Your job here is to write and arrange a rhythm part for the following track. The song is supposed to be in the Latin genre, so pick rhythms that you feel would assist in promoting that style. Take note of the new "/" sign we are seeing as well. This indicates a single beat, but does note necessarily mean you should play a quarter note there. It's just letting you know how many beats that chord is supposed to be present during.

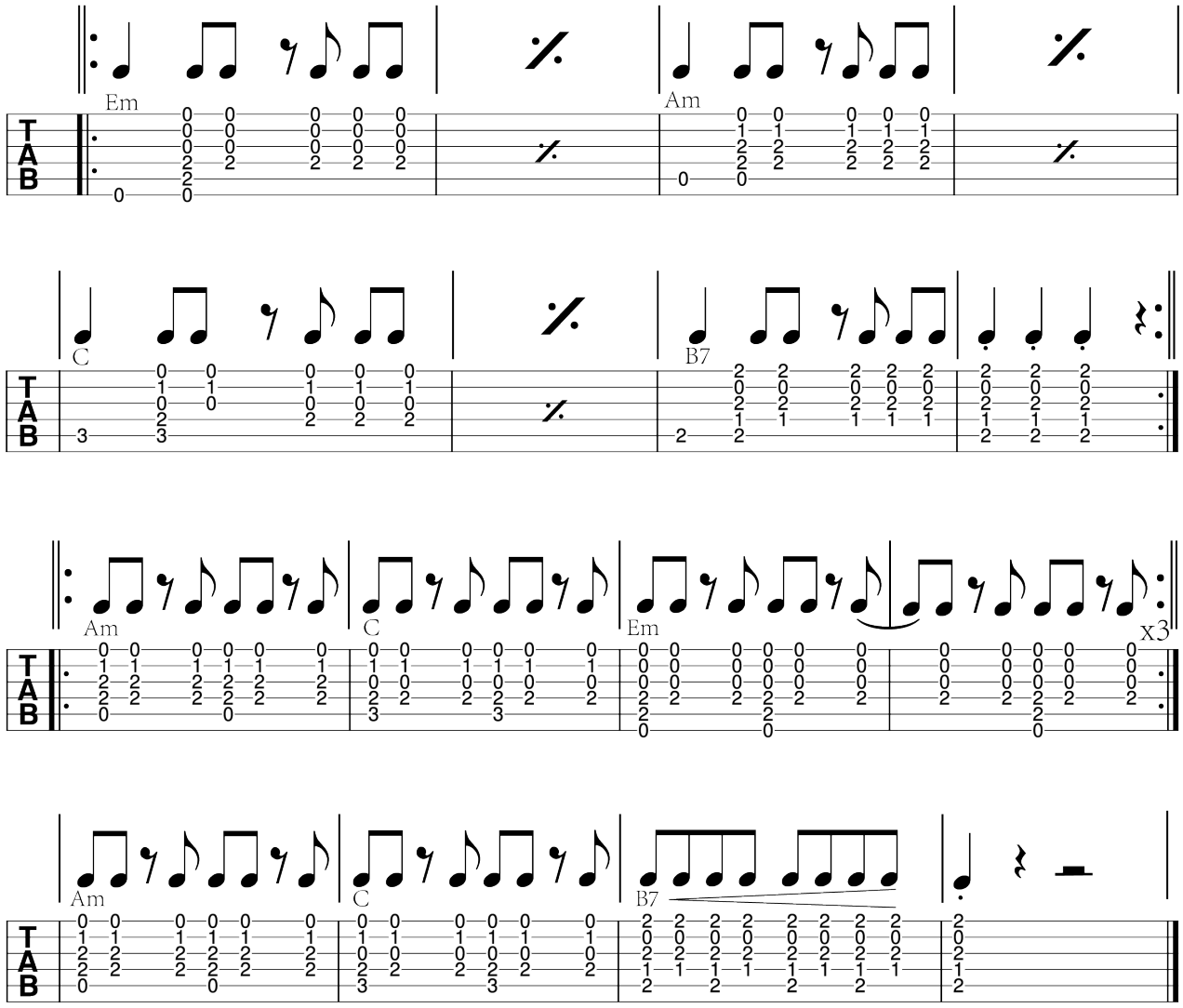
Feel free to use different chord shapes than the ones provided below. Once you're finished, play along with the included mp3 track to see how it interacts with the rhythms already provided.





Example (Video #17.1)

Here's an example of how one might arrange the previous chord sheets, notated for guitar tablature. Above the tablature is a simplified version of how you might notate the same ideas.



Repeat All - End on Em